
Seven things worth checking in your Google Ads account.

None of them are clever. All of them are free to fix. Most accounts we open have at least four.

WRITTEN FOR

Owners
2-30 crews

READ TIME

6 minutes
Checks are standalone

WHAT IT COSTS

Nothing
No signup

PUBLISHED BY

Make It Ring
makeitring.co

Before you start

Most accounts we open have at least four of these seven problems. None of them are clever, none of them cost anything to fix, and all of them are costing you money right now.

You do not need us to check any of this. Everything below takes a few minutes and you can do it yourself in your own account. If you find three or more, that is worth knowing either way.

ONE THING ABOUT SEASONALITY

Every trade has a peak and a quiet stretch. Whatever else you fix, make sure someone is answering during your peak. A quarter of calls going to voicemail means a quarter of your budget is gone, and no bidding change recovers it. Whatever else you fix, make sure someone is answering during your peak. A quarter of calls going to voicemail means a quarter of your budget is gone, and no bidding change recovers it.

The seven

01

Your ads go to your homepage

They should go to a page about the one thing the ad is selling. A homepage is built for everyone — it has your about page, your other services, your careers link. Someone who just clicked an ad wants one thing, and every other option on that page is a reason to leave without calling.

CHECK IT YOURSELF

Click your own ad on your phone. Where does it land? If it is your homepage, that is the problem.

02

You cannot take the work you are already getting

This is the most expensive problem on the list, and it is not an ads problem. If you are booked out and turning people away, you are paying for calls you cannot use. Worse, those customers go to a competitor and usually stay there. Fix capacity before you spend another dollar on ads.

CHECK IT YOURSELF

How many calls last week did you turn down, or push out more than a week? If it is more than a couple, your budget is higher than your capacity right now. Turn the budget down until you have another crew.

03

You are applying whatever Google recommends

Google emails you suggestions and shows you an optimisation score. Almost every recommendation increases your spend. That is not the same as increasing your jobs. Nobody is lying to you — selling ads is simply what they do.

CHECK IT YOURSELF

Open the recommendations tab. Count how many would raise your budget. Apply the ones that genuinely make sense, ignore the rest, and stop chasing the score.

04

Your negative keyword list has not been touched in months

You probably have one. The question is when anyone last looked at it. New junk searches appear every month, so a list built once and forgotten stops working. This is the difference between having a negative list and maintaining one.

CHECK IT YOURSELF

Open your search terms report for the last 30 days and read it. You will find things like “jobs near me”, “how much does it cost”, “salary”, “how to do it yourself”. Add anything that is not a customer. Then do it again next month.

05

Your quote form asks too much

Every question is a place someone gives up. Nine fields is a form nobody finishes standing in a driveway on their phone. You can get the rest on the call.

CHECK IT YOURSELF

Count the fields on your form. If it is more than four, cut it back. Name, phone, address, and one question about the job is plenty.

06

You are using stock photos

Every company in your trade uses the same handful, including the smiling technician in a spotless uniform. People have seen them on lead broker sites and comparison pages, so they now read as a middleman rather than a local business. Photos of your own crew work better and cost nothing.

CHECK IT YOURSELF

Look at every photo on your website. Anything you did not take yourself should come off.

07

Your best work and your cheapest work share one campaign

Some of your jobs are worth several times others. When they share a budget the cheaper clicks win, simply because they are cheaper, so the system buys more of them. You end up spending most of your money chasing your smallest jobs.

CHECK IT YOURSELF

Open your campaigns. If your high value work and your low value work are in the same one, split them and give each its own budget.

make it ring

If you find three or more, it is worth a proper look.

We build and run Google Ads for local service businesses, and we report in booked jobs rather than clicks. Every engagement starts with a paid check of your account, so you see what you are buying before you commit to anything.

If your account turns out to be fine, we will tell you that and you keep the findings.

makeitring.co